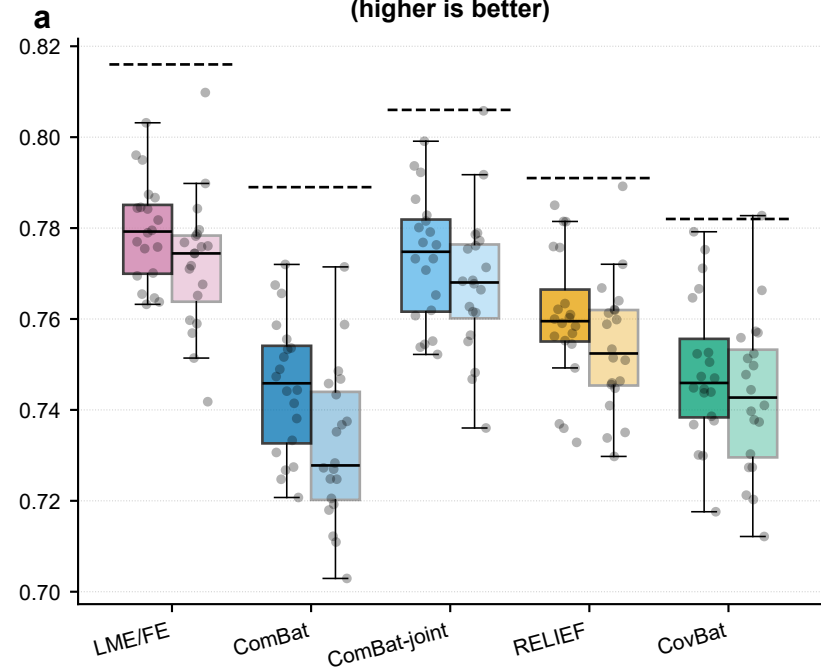


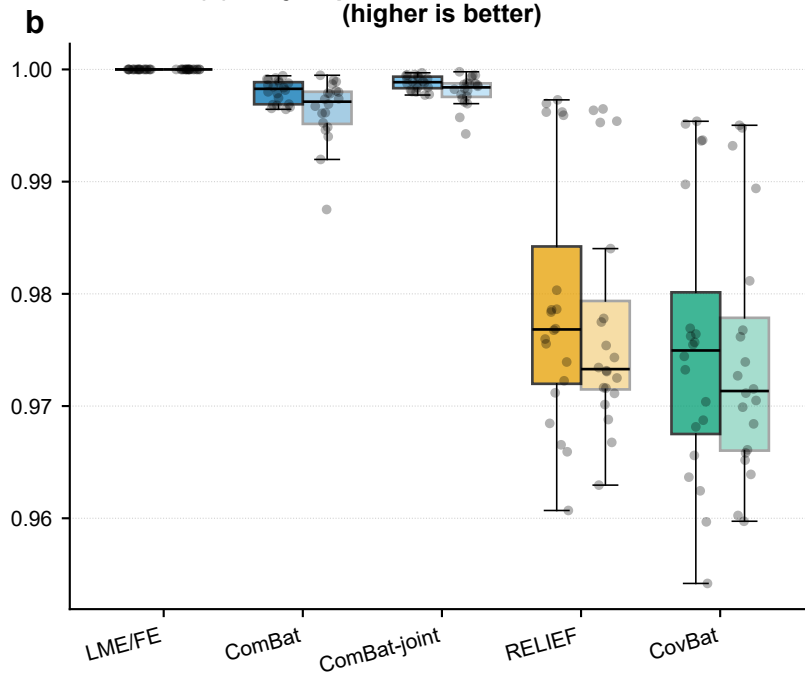
Design C subsample analyses: reduced-imbalance and true-equal-n (HC cohort, 20 random seeds each)

Reduced imbalance (n ≈ 98) True equal-n (n=75) ---- Full-cohort pooled r (Table 2)

(a) Subject preservation, pooled $r_{pre,post}$
(higher is better)



(b) Subject preservation, within-vendor r
(higher is better)



(c) Residual vendor η^2
(lower is better)

